

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR FAMILY
REVIEW



The Architecture of Grace

BOOK TWO · THE FRAMEWORK

Home Edition

FOR FAMILIES · GRADES 3-5

The complete year-long curriculum — every lesson,
undiluted — re-engineered for delivery by a parent at
home, one conversation at a time.

FREE PREVIEW

This free preview includes the parent's opening letter, how to use the book, the
crisis & safety quick-reference, and the first complete lesson — read it end to end.
The full 4 units · 28 lessons are available in the Store.

Before You Begin

A letter to the parent of a child in grades 3, 4, or 5

This book hands you the entire Architecture of Grace · Framework curriculum — the grades 3–5 year — **nothing simplified, nothing left out**. What changes is the delivery. In school a teacher runs these lessons with a class, journals, and mentor texts. Here, you are the guide, your kitchen table is the classroom, and the work happens in small, real conversations.

Grades 3–5 is where the inner critic gets loud. Your child is now old enough to narrate their own failures — “I’m stupid,” “everyone hates me,” “I always ruin everything” — and to believe it. This year’s spine is the difference between **guilt** (I did something wrong — fixable) and **shame** (I am wrong — a lie). Autistic children, corrected and misread more than their peers, are especially prone to wiring that shame deep. This curriculum exists to interrupt it before it hardens.

WHAT WE NEED TO TELL YOU — DIRECTLY

Autistic children are at elevated risk for self-harm and suicidal thoughts — not because of autism, but because of bullying, sensory overload, the exhaustion of masking, and being chronically misunderstood. In the 3–5 years this can start to show as withdrawal, a harsh self-story, or sudden shutdowns. If your child tells you, in any way — words, writing, behavior — that they don’t want to be here, take it seriously the first time. Don’t argue. Don’t ask why. Get help.

A few things this book asks of you:

- ◆ **When the school day ends in a shutdown — believe it.** The withdrawal at 3:30 is the bill for holding it together until 3:00 — the cost of masking, not defiance or rudeness.
- ◆ **Let the mask come off at home.** Stimming, scripting, deep dives into a special interest — none of these are problems. Unmasking in your kitchen means your home is safe.
- ◆ **Believe their read of the world.** Autistic children are more likely to be disbelieved when they report being hurt or left out. Don’t be the adult who adds to that.
- ◆ **Regulate first, then talk.** No hard conversation lands when a child is flooded or shut down. This year gives them — and you — a regulation toolkit. Use it before the lesson, not instead of it.
- ◆ **When a lesson is bigger than you — say so.** “This one is hard. Let’s ask your counselor.” That isn’t failing. It models exactly what this curriculum teaches.

ONE MORE THING

You are not failing if your child shuts down, goes quiet, or insists the harsh story is just true. You are not failing if a lesson takes three tries, or three months. You are reading this. You are trying. That is the work.

ORIENTATION

How to Use This Book

A flip book — one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like

There are **28 lessons**, grouped into 4 units, plus a **Regulation & Repair Strand** module in each unit — the signature of the grades 3–5 year. You do not have to teach them in order. Open to a lesson, read it once, and let it surface over the week — at meals, in the car, on a walk, at bedtime.

Every lesson is built from the same six parts — once you know the shape of one, you know them all:

① CORE DIRECT INSTRUCTION — HOME DELIVERY

The actual school lesson — objective, concepts, and steps intact — rewritten for one child and one adult at home, in real conversation rather than a scheduled block.

② THE AUTISM LENS

Three fixed supports: Make It Literal & Concrete, Sensory Regulation (matched to the lesson's emotional load), and Universal Design for Communication — so the lesson works whether your child speaks, types, uses AAC, points, or draws.

③ ELITE CONVERSATION STARTERS

Low-pressure, one-question prompts tagged to the natural moments of a day — each paired with a script to model on yourself first.

④ PRINTABLE VISUAL ASSETS & CHARTS

Ready-to-print anchor charts and home tools — fridge-and-binder versions of the classroom's visuals.

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

On every lesson: a clear line for when to bring in a professional. On high-stakes lessons this band grows — and tells you plainly when a conversation belongs to your child's counselor, not to you alone.

♦ PARENT REFLECTION

One private question after each lesson. Not homework. A place to put what the lesson stirred up — because it will.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE THREE MINUTES

Read the Crisis & Safety page next. Then read Lesson 1 (Who Am I?) and Lesson 5 (Guilt vs. Shame). Those three pages are the foundation of everything else.

QUICK REFERENCE · KEEP THIS PAGE VISIBLE

If You Need Help Right Now

Crisis & safety numbers — fill in the local line before you ever need it

988	Suicide & Crisis Lifeline — call or text · 24/7 · free
741741	Crisis Text Line — text HOME · for when speaking isn't possible
911	Immediate danger. If you can, ask for a CIT-trained officer and say your child is autistic.
—	Your local mobile crisis line — write it here now: _____

A NOTE ON CALLING 911

Police interactions can be dangerous for autistic people if officers are not trained. When possible, call mobile crisis, your pediatrician, or 988 first. Reserve 911 for immediate physical danger.

FOR THE PARENT OF AN AUTISTIC CHILD

In the 3–5 years, distress often shows as withdrawal, shutdown, somatic complaints, or a sudden change — not the words “I feel sad.” Watch the whole child. When in doubt, ask your pediatrician or counselor. You are never overreacting by checking.

UNIT ONE



Knowing & Accepting Yourself

Unit 1 lays the interior foundation. A child cannot extend compassion outward until they have an honest, stable sense of who they are — and the bone-deep knowledge that they are more than their worst moment. This unit builds the vocabulary (strengths,

emotions, the inner critic, guilt vs. shame) and the regulation toolkit everything else depends on.

AUGUST – OCTOBER · SEVEN LESSONS

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · HOME EDITION

Who Am I? STANDARD

The first lesson of the year — building an honest, steady map of who your child is

OBJECTIVE

Your child names at least three personal strengths or values and can say why each makes them worthwhile.

CASEL FOCUS

Self-Awareness — identifying personal strengths and self-perception

VOCABULARY

identity · strength · value · character · still figuring out

AT HOME

35–40 min, or split across two sittings · Week 1

① Core Direct Instruction — Home Delivery

- 1 SAY WHAT YOU'RE BUILDING · 3 MIN** Before handing over anything: "Once a week, we're going to work on the inside of your life — not grades, but the part of you that decides how you treat yourself when things go wrong." Promise privacy. Establish: feelings are information; every person is more than their worst moment.
- 2 THE HOME COMPACT · 5 MIN** Ask: "What do you need this to feel like, to be honest here?" Make sure four lines are included: what's shared here stays here · you never have to share more than you choose · feelings are information · we use the Inner Coach voice with each other. Post it.
- 3 BUILD THE IDENTITY WEB · 10 MIN** Name in the center; five branches — Things I Love · Good At · Matter to Me · People Don't Know · Still Figuring Out. You model your own first. Drawing is a full answer; push grade 4–5 toward values, not just interests.
- 4 STRENGTHS INVENTORY · 8 MIN** From a character-strengths list, your child circles three that feel most true and says one sentence for each. Grade 4–5 stretch: "Which strength did you have to build through effort?"
- 5 ONE TRUE THING · 5 MIN** Your child writes one true thing about themselves that often goes unseen, onto a card for the family display. "This is who you are." No pressure to share more.

② The Autism Lens

◆ **Make It Literal & Concrete** “Name a strength” is abstract under pressure. Offer the strengths list as a **menu to choose from**, not a blank to fill. “Still Figuring Out” is a real, honest branch — for a child who fears getting it “wrong,” it removes the trap of having to be finished.

◆ **Sensory Regulation — tied to this theme** Being seen is the load here. Lower the demand: **side-by-side, not face-to-face**, writing or drawing instead of speaking, a calm window, a fidget within reach. Opting out of sharing is built in, not a failure.

◆ **Universal Design for Communication Write, type, draw, or say it** — all equal. **AAC** to select a strength. **Point** to the branch. “Not sure yet” is an honest, accepted answer — note where it isn’t before pushing for where it is.

③ Elite Conversation Starters

MEALTIME “If you made an identity web, what’s one branch you’d fill first? I’ll go — mine is ____.”

CAR “What’s a strength of yours that you had to **work** to build, not one you were born with?”

BEDTIME “Name one true thing about you that most people don’t get to see.”

PARENT SCRIPT — MODEL IT ON YOURSELF

“Here’s mine: I love a quiet morning, I’m good at fixing things, and a value that matters to me is keeping my word — which I had to **build**, I wasn’t born patient. Your turn, or just one if one’s enough.”

④ Printable Visual Assets & Charts

MY IDENTITY WEB

CENTER: MY NAME · FIVE BRANCHES ALL ABOUT ME ME Things I Love · Things I’m Good At · Things That Matter to Me · People Don’t Know This · Things I’m Still Figuring Out

CHARACTER STRENGTHS — CHOOSE THREE

A MENU TO PICK FROM · CIRCLE THE THREE MOST TRUE kind · curious · brave · honest · creative · loyal · funny · patient · fair · determined · careful · calm

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

Low-risk, but a window into self-perception. Watch for a child who can name nothing and answers “I don’t know” to every prompt, or who writes a card and immediately crumples it — early, meaningful data, not something to push on. If an answer names a real hurt or unsafe situation, that’s a conversation for your child’s counselor or pediatrician, not something to resolve inside the lesson.

◆ PARENT REFLECTION

Could my child name strengths — or did they default to “I don’t know” and minimize? Which branch came easily, and which made them go quiet?

END OF FREE PREVIEW

That was Lesson 1 of 4 units • 28 lessons.

The free preview ends here — you've just read the parent's letter, the orientation, the crisis & safety reference, and the first complete lesson, exactly as a family would use it at the kitchen table. The rest of the year continues in the same shape: one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like.

- ◆ Every lesson built from the same six parts — once you know one, you know them all.
- ◆ The Autism Lens on every lesson: Make It Literal, Sensory Regulation, and Universal Design for Communication.
- ◆ Elite conversation starters tagged to the real moments of a day — each with a script to model first.
- ◆ Printable anchor charts and home tools, plus a Safety & Escalation band and a Parent Reflection on every lesson.

Take it home.

The complete The Framework Home Edition — all 4 units • 28 lessons, undiluted — is available in the Store. A check-in, not an exam; a curriculum, not a worksheet.